■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Monday, August 17, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *Judge clears Nine PBS to retrieve 70 years of archival TV data — court rules station owns 50TB of data in Iron Mountain servers after host went under*

The Angle: *Judge clears Nine PBS to retrieve 70 years of archival TV data — court rules station owns 50TB of data in Iron Mountain servers after host went under*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/software/cloud-storage/judge-clears-nine-pbs-to-retrieve-70-years-of-archival-tv-data-court-rules-station-owns-50tb-of-data-in-iron-mountain-servers-after-host-went-under

■ *Free Blockbusters are popping up to bring back physical media*

The Angle: *Free Blockbusters are popping up to bring back physical media*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.popsci.com/technology/free-blockbuster-stands/

■ *South Africa just switched on Africa's largest solar and battery project, combining 216 MW of solar with 500 MWh of storage to provide clean electricity for about 200,000 homes from 5am to 9:30pm*

The Angle: *South Africa just switched on Africa's largest solar and battery project, combining 216 MW of solar with 500 MWh of storage to provide clean electricity for about 200,000 homes from 5am to 9:30pm*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://totalenergies.co.za/news/totalenergies-inaugurates-africas-largest-hybrid-renewable-project

■ *Blood Test Predicts Alzheimer's Risk a Decade Early*

The Angle: *Blood Test Predicts Alzheimer's Risk a Decade Early*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://aaic.alz.org/releases-2026/blood-test-p-tau217-predicts-alzheimers-risk.asp

■ *We Tracked a Shipment of Rare Books. It Ended at an Amazon AI Training Facility / The shipment was found at an Amazon facility where Amazon scans and destroys books*

The Angle: *We Tracked a Shipment of Rare Books. It Ended at an Amazon AI Training Facility / The shipment was found at an Amazon facility where Amazon scans and destroys books*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.404media.co/we-tracked-a-shipment-of-rare-books-it-ended-at-an-amazon-ai-training-facility/

Backup options:

■ *It Is Past Time for You to Quit Elon Musk's X*

The Angle: *It Is Past Time for You to Quit Elon Musk's X*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://publiccomment.blog/p/it-is-past-time-for-you-to-quit-elon-musk-s-x

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■ *The economy has spoken. Stuff that's AI-generated has almost zero value — "Buyers are voting with their wallets, and AI-generated content is struggling to compete."*

The Angle: *The economy has spoken. Stuff that's AI-generated has almost zero value — "Buyers are voting with their wallets, and AI-generated content is struggling to compete."*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://finance.yahoo.com/technology/ai/articles/economy-spoken-stuff-ai-generated-142732314.html

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■ *Microsoft confirms GitHub is down worldwide*

The Angle: *Microsoft confirms GitHub is down worldwide*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/microsoft/microsoft-confirms-github-is-down-worldwide/

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Russian teenager faces misdemeanour charge for listening to 'extremist' song*

The Angle: *Russian teenager faces misdemeanour charge for listening to 'extremist' song*

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://novayagazeta.eu/en/articles/2026/08/17/russian-teenager-faces-misdemeanour-charge-for-listening-to-extremist-song-en-news

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■ *Narcan 'was found in apartment where Hayden Panettiere died of suspected overdose', as neighbor describes scene that unfolded*

The Angle: *Narcan 'was found in apartment where Hayden Panettiere died of suspected overdose', as neighbor describes scene that unfolded*

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.dailymail.com/news/article-16058613/hayden-panettiere-overdose-death-greenville-neighbor.html

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■ *A group of Gandalfs protesting in front of Peter Thiel's (Owner of mass surveillance company Palantir) house in Buenos Aires, Argentina*

The Angle: *A group of Gandalfs protesting in front of Peter Thiel's (Owner of mass surveillance company Palantir) house in Buenos Aires, Argentina*

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/4l4hrtij91kh1

■ *Netanyahu puts NYC mayor Mamdani alongside Iran's Ayatollah on enemies poster*

The Angle: *Netanyahu puts NYC mayor Mamdani alongside Iran's Ayatollah on enemies poster*

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.the-independent.com/news/world/middle-east/mamdani-netanyahu-poster-israel-b3034086.html

Backup options:

■ *NYC Mayor Zohran Mamdani speaking Mandarin to promote free Broadway tickets for the city's high school students.*

The Angle: *NYC Mayor Zohran Mamdani speaking Mandarin to promote free Broadway tickets for the city's high school students.*

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/5qmt6l3wbzjh1

■ *'The Fast and The Furious' 25th anniversary screening red carpet: Vin Diesel, Meadow Walker, Jordana Brewster and more*

The Angle: *'The Fast and The Furious' 25th anniversary screening red carpet: Vin Diesel, Meadow Walker, Jordana Brewster and more*

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/17/photos/the-fast-and-the-furious-25th-anniversary-screening-red-carpet-vin-diesel-meadow-walker-jordana-brewster-and-more/

■ *Socialist congressional candidate slams white Dem primary opponent for running in a majority-black area*

The Angle: *Socialist congressional candidate slams white Dem primary opponent for running in a majority-black area*

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/17/us-news/socialist-congressional-candidate-slams-white-dem-primary-opponent-for-running-in-a-majority-black-area/

■ *Latest Buss family drama is like a real-life episode of 'Succession'*

The Angle: *Latest Buss family drama is like a real-life episode of 'Succession'*

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/17/sports/latest-buss-family-drama-is-like-a-real-life-episode-of-succession/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Honey loses over 7 million users and 7,000 stores following YouTuber's viral expose*

The Angle: *Honey loses over 7 million users and 7,000 stores following YouTuber's viral expose*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.dexerto.com/youtube/honey-loses-over-7-million-users-and-7000-stores-following-youtubers-viral-expose-3397619/

Backup options:

■ *Women in Fancy Beverly Hills Steakhouse Brawl Reveal What Sparked Fight - TMZ*

The Angle: *Women in Fancy Beverly Hills Steakhouse Brawl Reveal What Sparked Fight - TMZ*

TMZ (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tmz.com/2026/08/16/fancy-beverly-hills-steakhouse-fight-explained/

■ *Meta faces a $1.4 trillion reckoning in latest trial over social media addiction*

The Angle: *Meta faces a $1.4 trillion reckoning in latest trial over social media addiction*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.engadget.com/2237547/meta-faces-a-1-4-trillion-reckoning-in-latest-trial-over-social-media-addiction/

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Study Finds People Who Consumed Sugar-Sweetened Beverages on a Daily Basis Had Higher Risk of Stomach Cancer*

The Angle: *Study Finds People Who Consumed Sugar-Sweetened Beverages on a Daily Basis Had Higher Risk of Stomach Cancer*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.massgeneralbrigham.org/en/about/newsroom/press-releases/daily-sugar-sweetened-beverages-higher-risk-of-stomach-cancer

Backup options:

■ *Of more than 500 occupations in the United States, flight attendants and pilots have the highest and second-highest proportion of radiation-related cancer deaths, a new study has found.*

The Angle: *Of more than 500 occupations in the United States, flight attendants and pilots have the highest and second-highest proportion of radiation-related cancer deaths, a new study has found.*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://hms.harvard.edu/news/pilots-flight-attendants-have-greater-risk-radiation-related-cancer-death-other-professions

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■ *Attention can regulate acute inflammation in humans. The findings raises the possibility that our subjective experience of what is happening in the body is not only a passive process, but may be actively contributing to how physiological responses are regulated*

The Angle: *Attention can regulate acute inflammation in humans. The findings raises the possibility that our subjective experience of what is happening in the body is not only a passive process, but may be actively contributing to how physiological responses are regulated*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.eurekalert.org/news-releases/1140025

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *The CEO who fired 900 people on Zoom just before Christmas wants his job back*

The Angle: *The CEO who fired 900 people on Zoom just before Christmas wants his job back*

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://abc7chicago.com/story/vishal-garg-ceo-better-home-finance-fired-900-people-zoom-before-christmas-wants-job-back/19686905/

Backup options:

■ *AGAR: Toronto bike lanes ruling sheds light on legal system*

The Angle: *AGAR: Toronto bike lanes ruling sheds light on legal system*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/opinion/columnists/toronto-bike-lanes-ruling-sheds-light-on-legal-system

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FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/4 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *CEO who fired 900 employees over Zoom gets fired, demands job back*

The Angle: *CEO who fired 900 employees over Zoom gets fired, demands job back*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://local12.com/news/nation-world/ceo-fired-zoom-vishal-garg-better-home-finance-demands-job-back-call-holiday-season-2021-roles-reversed-tables-turned-chief-executive-officer-ousted-board-company-stock-price-market-value

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■ *Big Tech is spending $500 million on a political campaign against Universal Basic Income.*

The Angle: *Big Tech is spending $500 million on a political campaign against Universal Basic Income.*

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/r/Futurology/comments/1vqqv15/big_tech_is_spending_500_million_on_a_political/

■ *China adds an 800-passenger jet with ‘flying wing’ body to its big aircraft plan*

The Angle: *China adds an 800-passenger jet with ‘flying wing’ body to its big aircraft plan*

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.scmp.com/news/china/science/article/3364006/china-adds-800-passenger-jet-flying-wing-body-its-big-aircraft-plan?utm_source=Reddit&utm_medium=Social

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■ *Doctors Found 4 Autoimmune Diseases in One Woman at One Time: 40-year-old woman in China was already diagnosed with 3 - ulcerative colitis, autoimmune hepatitis and primary sclerosing cholangitis. She presented with severe iron deficiency and was also found to have a 4th - autoimmune gastritis.*

The Angle: *Doctors Found 4 Autoimmune Diseases in One Woman at One Time: 40-year-old woman in China was already diagnosed with 3 - ulcerative colitis, autoimmune hepatitis and primary sclerosing cholangitis. She presented with severe iron deficiency and was also found to have a 4th - autoimmune gastritis.*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/doctors-found-4-autoimmune-diseases-in-one-woman-at-one-time

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■ *Historically, there was very strong guidance that you must always finish an antibiotic course. Now, we're seeing a growing body of evidence saying that that is not always the case. And oftentimes, shorter durations of antibiotics are as effective and safe as longer*

alternatives.

The Angle: *Historically, there was very strong guidance that you must always finish an antibiotic course. Now, we're seeing a growing body of evidence saying that that is not always the case. And oftentimes, shorter durations of antibiotics are as effective and safe as longer alternatives.*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/always-finish-your-antibiotics-is-not-always-best-practice-surprised-youre-not-alone

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■ *Less than 20% of Canadians want to give U.S. 'concessions,' poll finds*

The Angle: *Less than 20% of Canadians want to give U.S. 'concessions,' poll finds*

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://globalnews.ca/news/12023832/canadians-trump-tariffs/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Don Lemon and sexy Smurf joke make for bizarre scene, and more items from the column" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner's face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)
- "NYC women's shelter brings cat fights, junkies and bizarre antics to neighborhood near playground https://t.co/khWuUTWRRt https://t.co/HwXL2" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-13)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 17 banked (+15 each when found)

- "'Everybody Loves Raymond' star Patricia Heaton backs calls to ban Mayor Zohran Mamdani from 9/11 anniversary in NYC https://t.co/UCpYAdZR5o " (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Boy George Drops Out of 'Jesus Christ Superstar' After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone" (Rolling Stone (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-31)
- "'Sunday in the Park with George' Producers Confirm Summer 2027 Show Will Go On 'As Planned' After Ariana Grande Exits" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Nordstrom Anniversary Sale Ends Soon — 27 Steals From Hollywood's Most-Loved Labels" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Rosie O'Donnell's 'The View' reunion comments spark alumni meltdown over invites" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-08-04)
- "Anniversary of capybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)
- "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn't Invited to Partake in 'Wizards of Waverly Place' Revival: "Disappointed"" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-07)
- "Japan commemorates 81st anniversary of the atomic bombing of Nagasaki - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-09)
- "Where to Watch 'Real Housewives Ultimate Girls Trip: Roaring 20th' Anniversary Series Online" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-09)
- "Animal Justice holds one year anniversary rally at St. Joseph's Hospital" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-10)
- ""Roseanne" Child Star Michael Fishman Slams Idea That the Show's Revival Was Unjustly Canceled: 'Words Have Consequences' - Yahoo" (PEOPLE (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-11)
- "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-12)
- "Chip Gaines Makes Rare Appearance with Wife Joanna on Magnolia Journal's Milestone 10th Anniversary Cover - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "'Cause we (still) rock! The Jonas Brothers introduce a new generation in nostalgia-filled Camp Rock 3 (exclusive)" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "Ugly inning, quiet bats doom Yankees in disappointing loss to Blue Jays" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-14)
- "JENNIE hears the BLINKs, and now, she's sharing regrets from her heart after fans expressed they were feeling let down by the lack of celebr" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-17)

- "Vin Diesel and Meadow Walker arrive to "The Fast and the Furious" 25th Anniversary Screening in LA https://t.co/zDNowKjfdg" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-08-17)

Newly banked this run:

- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "JENNIE hears the BLINKs, and now, she’s sharing regrets from her heart after fans expressed they were feeling let down by the lack of celebr"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Vin Diesel and Meadow Walker arrive to "The Fast and the Furious" 25th Anniversary Screening in LA https://t.co/zDNowKjfdg"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-08-17 11:34 PM